

Feed than what's provided normally. It even lets you access the stream, read content from the stream, publish your own content, and manage comments and ratings for individual Feed stories from outside Facebook, whether it be on an external web site, a mobile application, or a desktop application.

2.2 Test console

You can learn a lot about the API's functionality by using the Facebook API Test Console. Go to the URL <http://developers.facebook.com> to access the Facebook developers' section in your browser. Click on the link to the Tools page or go directly to <http://developers.facebook.com/tools.php>.

The API Test Console has a number of fields:

User ID - A read-only field which displays your user ID number.

Response Format - This is used to select the type of response that you want:

- XML
- JSON
- Facebook PHP Client
- Callback - With this, you can encapsulate the response in a function if you are using XML or JSON.
- Method - To insert the actual Facebook method that you want to test.
- The Test Console also has the documentation link which is used to select a method from the drop-down list, and view its documentation which consists of:
 - A description of the method
 - The parameters used by the method
 - An example return XML
 - A description of the expected response.
 - The FQL equivalent
 - Error codes

API Essentials

API calls are your first interaction points with the platform. You don't need to use the client library; but it just makes things easier since you would need to write these in your language in order to interact with the platform.

To set up the client library for PHP, just include the client library in your code.

For example, the code to make sure that users are logged on to Facebook before displaying a list of the user's friends goes like: